

STANDBY

A Romantic Comedy Feature

A woman paid to go on other people's first dates falls for the man doing the exact same job for his best friend, and the only way either of them can be together for real means unraveling the identity fraud their whole business was built on.

GENRE	FORMAT	LENGTH	SETTING
Romantic Comedy	Feature, TV Movie or Streaming Original	89 pages	Atlanta, GA (contained, single city)

SYNOPSIS

CHLOE MARSH, 27, runs StandBy, a discreet Atlanta dating consultancy that sends trained professionals on first dates in her clients' place, using banked voice recordings and a shared device to fool BlindMatch, a dating app built on obsessive identity verification. BEN WHITFIELD, 29, an ambitious young architect, does the same job off the books for his anxious best friend Mark. When their clients match, Chloe and Ben are sent to screen each other, and fall for each other instead, under names that are not their own. What starts as one date becomes a secret relationship built on borrowed identities, spiraling lies to the people who trust them most, and a verification system engineered to catch exactly this. When the truth collides in public at the industry's biggest event of the year, both of them have to decide what the lie cost, and whether what is left underneath it is worth keeping.

WHY NOW

Dating app fatigue, catfishing anxiety, and identity verification are part of the current cultural conversation. STANDBY turns that anxiety into a rom com engine nobody has used yet: what happens when the people hired to protect you from a lie fall for each other while living one.

COMPS

Set It Up meets Cyrano de Bergerac, with the institutional bite of a fraud thriller kept firmly inside a rom com frame. Plays broader than a pure romance without ever leaving the genre.

KEY SELLING POINTS

- One sentence hook that sells itself in a scroll or a pitch meeting
- Contained Atlanta production: mostly interiors, no stunts or vehicles beyond driving, one standing event set for the climax
- Six substantial, castable roles across two generations, with a built in second couple for a two for one romance engine
- Real institutional stakes, fraud exposure, legal jeopardy, public scandal, without ever leaving the rom com lane
- Production friendly, tax incentive state setting

BUYER FIT

LIFETIME	A female led POV, a heroine whose business and reputation are on the line, a betrayal she is the one committing, and a mother daughter relationship at the center of it.
TUBI	The premise is the trailer. One sentence sells the whole movie, escalation starts in the first ten pages, and the gala collision is a shareable, clip ready set piece.
TV ONE	Accessible relationship stakes, a Black led ensemble available in casting, family legacy themes on both sides of the couple, and a contained, deliverable production plan.

PRODUCTION SNAPSHOT

Single city, Atlanta. Mostly interior locations (offices, restaurants, apartments, a speakeasy, a hardware store). One event night for the climax. No stunts, no vehicles beyond driving, no visual effects. Cast load: six leads, four to six supporting. Content suitable for basic cable and ad supported streaming.

PACKAGE STATUS	WRITTEN BY	CONTACT
Complete feature screenplay, fourth draft, ready for read. NCCA Entertainment attached to produce.	KT, NCCA Entertainment	kelly.tenney@gmail.com